STREE (2018)

Made on a shoestring budget of Rs 20-25 crore, the film took in Rs 124 crore. Two years later, Vijan would fiddle with the idea of creating a horror comedy universe by intertwining characters from *Stree* into *Bhediya* (2022). The rest is history



STREE 2 (2024)

Part II was expected to fare well but few would have predicted that it would be the highest grossing Hindi film ever domestically (Rs 585 crore). In director Amar Kaushik, Vijan has a creative collaborator who helps him build the IP [intellectual property] of the horcom universe

not as media savvy as Karan Johar of Dharma Productions either. On the back of the two films alone, Maddock has been propelled to the A-League—a force to reckon with, the studio on every film professional's wishlist. "How people look at you changes with success," says Vijan. He was in Shirdi days before the release of *Bhool Chuk Maaf*. Visiting the holy temple has become a ritual since his hit film *Zara Hatke Zara Bachke* (2023). "It helps to take the stress away of release," he adds.

One reason why Maddock is a behemoth in Bollywood is the horror comedy universe that has become its trump card. Unlike YRF's spy universe, it's distinctly Indian, with stories